

Generative Pages

Build the same Northwind Traders Orders experience twice — once with no code, once with GitHub Copilot.

Both labs work over the Northwind Traders solution and produce an Orders record gallery bound to Dataverse. Lab A stays in the Power Apps maker studio and uses Describe a page. Lab B produces the same kind of page from Visual Studio Code with the GitHub Copilot CLI genpage skill, so the result can be committed and promoted like any other developer artifact. Run either lab on its own in 30 minutes, or both back to back.

Before you start

Complete this setup before the clock starts — installation and data seeding are not part of the 30 minutes. Type the supplied prompts verbatim, accept the agent's recommended options, and move on once a checkpoint is met; generation is non-deterministic, so pace matters more than polish.

Requirement	Detail
Environment	A Power Platform environment (dev or sandbox) where your account has Maker permissions and Dataverse access.
Solution and data	Northwind Traders 1.0.0.11 or later, imported and seeded with the Northwind Sample Data App.
Lab B tooling	Visual Studio Code with GitHub Copilot, Node.js LTS, .NET SDK, PAC CLI 2.3.1 or later, and the Model Apps plugin (/plugin install model-apps@power-platform-skills).
Licensing	A Power Apps Premium licence for users who run the model-driven app.

Lab A — No-code: Orders gallery in Power Apps Studio

Add a generative page to the Admin Management app that presents Northwind orders as a modern card gallery, opens the underlying order record on selection, and lets the user switch between light and dark themes. Three prompts, no code.

- Go to make.preview.powerapps.com, select Solutions, then open Northwind Traders > Apps > Admin Management App > Edit > Edit in new tab.
- Select Add page, then Describe a page, and add the Order table from the Northwind Traders solution. Enter the prompt below and select Generate.

Build a page showing Order records as a gallery of cards using modern look & feel. All cards should have fixed size and are tall enough to fit 4 lines of titles with labels and values. Include Order Number, Customer Name, Payment Type & Paid Date. Make the component fill 100% of the space, responsive and scroll vertically. Make the gallery scrollable. Use data from the attached Order table. Make the Customer Name the title of the card and make the order number the subtitle of the card.

- Preview the gallery, then make each card open its Northwind order record.

Make each card clickable to open the Order record in a modal dialog. Use the XRM navigateTo method to open the edit form in the modal dialog. Use the accent color border on hover.

- Test card navigation. "Error loading control" inside the app designer is expected and clears once the app is published. Then add a theme switch.

Add a switch in the header of the page for the user to toggle between dark mode and light mode. Dark mode colors are background: black and accent: green; light mode colors are background: white and accent: purple. Ensure card backgrounds and labels match the theme selected and continue to be fully accessible.

- Set the page title to Orders page, then Save, Publish, and play the Admin Management app.

Checkpoint: the Orders page is published in the Admin Management app, scrolls through Northwind order cards, opens the order record in a modal dialog, and switches cleanly between dark and light themes.

Lab B — Pro-code: Orders page with GitHub Copilot CLI

Generate the same Orders experience from Visual Studio Code using the genpage skill, bound to the nwind_orders, nwind_order_details, and nwind_products tables, then publish it into a new model-driven app and refine it with two prompts.

- Open Visual Studio Code in your lab working directory, start GitHub Copilot CLI Chat, type / to list skills, and run /model-apps:genpage.
- Select the environment that contains the Northwind Traders solution, choose Create a new page, select Other, and enter this description.

I want a modern looking page for Orders. Users should be able to view Orders and their related data. When I select an Order, the record should expand and show me the related order details and the product associated with that Order. Use the nwind_orders, nwind_order_details, and nwind_products tables from the Northwind Traders solution.

- Select Yes to confirm, choose All of the above (Recommended), select Looks good, proceed! on the execution plan, and approve any file-read requests. If the agent picks up similarly named tables from another solution, correct it in the chat.

The tables we want are in the Northwind Traders solution with prefix nwind_. nwind_orders, nwind_orderdetails, nwind_products

- When generation completes select Publish, then ask the agent to create the app rather than picking an existing one: Create a new app named Northwind Orders Gen Page. Select Verify in browser.
- Back in the chat, apply a modern style and highlight high-cost shipments.

Apply a modern, visually expressive style suitable for a model-driven app page, while preserving clarity and accessibility. Use brighter, saturated colors for page headers and section titles, and lighter tints of those colors for section backgrounds. Keep body content on neutral surfaces, add short hover and focus transitions only, and preserve visible focus indicators and clear contrast ratios. Also highlight the records where shipping fee is > \$50.

- Improve what a user sees when an order is expanded.

When a user expands an order, render an expanded view that includes detailed order information, shipping details, and the complete shipping address. Display order and product information within a single, structured tile, positioned horizontally adjacent to the shipping details tile. Add an additional tile that shows the shipping address on an interactive map, automatically pinned and centered on the delivery address. Retain the scroll bar to navigate through the orders gallery.

- Edit the subarea in the sitemap and rename the page to Modern Order Page.

Checkpoint: the Northwind Orders Gen Page app opens in the browser with a styled Orders page, highlights orders with shipping fees over \$50, and shows a side-by-side expanded view with an interactive map.

Timing and troubleshooting

Use this breakdown to keep a delivered session on track.

Segment	Minutes	Notes
Lab A – generate the gallery	12	Open the app, add the Order table, run the first prompt, preview.
Lab A – cards and theme	13	Two refinement prompts; keep preview cycles short.
Lab A – publish	5	Rename, save, publish, and play the Admin Management app.
Lab B – generate and publish	18	Environment selection, plan confirmation, app creation, browser check.

Lab B – refine	12	Two prompts and the rename; the agent republishes automatically.
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Most issues in either lab fall into one of these four situations.

Situation	What to do
"Error loading control" in the designer	Expected while testing inside the app designer. Publish and run the app outside the designer to confirm behaviour.
The agent binds to the wrong tables	Remind it of the Northwind Traders solution and the nwind_ publisher prefix in the chat rather than regenerating.
The wrong environment is selected	Cancel the run, sign in with the account that owns the environment holding Northwind Traders, then re-invoke /model-apps:genpage.
Generation runs for several minutes	Expected for richer pages. Let the agent finish, and regenerate from scratch rather than patching a cancelled run.

Key takeaways

- The same generative pages capability is reachable from the maker studio and from GitHub Copilot, and both produce solution-aware pages inside Northwind Traders.
- Generate broad first, then refine one concern per prompt: interaction, then style, then layout.
- Ground every prompt in real data by naming the table, and in the pro-code path the solution and the nwind_ publisher prefix.
- Verify in the browser after each change, then treat the generated page like any other app artifact: rename it, review it, and promote it through solutions.